



ALEXANDRIA TEMPORAL INTEGRITY

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Owner: Orientation / Alexandria stewardship | **Related:** Canon, Semaphore, provenance, historical reconstruction | **Cross-reference:** CANON_INSTITUTIONAL_KNOWLEDGE.md; SEARCH_AND_HISTORICAL_RECONSTRUCTION.md

Time is a first-class property, not one timestamp. Where applicable Alexandria distinguishes when an event happened, when it was recorded, when Sable Harbor could access it, when a person or function understood it, and when it changed institutional understanding.

These dimensions answer different questions. Event time reconstructs reality; recorded time shows the contemporary artifact; access time constrains what the institution could use; understood time shows when meaning formed; institutional-change time identifies when Canon, EIB, a judgment, decision, model, or question actually moved.

The environment must support both:

- **What did Sable Harbor actually know on date X?** This uses institutional records, access, understanding, confidence, and dissent as they stood then.
- **What information existed or could reasonably have been known on date X?** This may include evidence then available but not yet found, routed, understood, or incorporated.

Those answers must not be conflated to reward or blame with hindsight. Later knowledge may annotate and explain an earlier record, create a correction, or supersede a state. It may never silently revise the earlier state as though Sable Harbor always knew. The institution remembers being wrong faithfully.

Current/active, disputed, unresolved, historical, corrected, and superseded states must be navigable. A state transition preserves predecessor, effective/change time, human author, reason, evidence, dissent, and downstream relationships. Legal/privacy deletion requirements may later remove content, but the architecture does not promise unlawful “never delete”; retention implementation remains OPEN.

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